

		liable. Additionally, Plaintiff has not alleged any controversy between it and Rader. The SAC does not allege Rader had any interest in the conveyance. Accordingly, the demurrer is sustained as to the 3rd cause of action. The Court finds the SAC is capable of amendment and, thus, grants leave to amend. (See <i>Scott v. City of Indian Wells</i> (1972) 6 Cal.3d 541, 549.)
4	Sanchez vs. Ford Motor Company 2024-01402402 Motion to Strike or Tax Costs	Defendant Ford Motor Company's (Ford) Motion to Tax Costs is GRANTED in part for a total amount taxed of \$363.00. Deposition costs are recoverable under Code of Civil Procedure section 1033.5, subdivision (a)(3)(A). Ford moves to tax \$3,813.88 for the cost associated with the deposition of Ford's person most knowledgeable on the ground it was unnecessary and unreasonable. Ford contends Plaintiff chose a significantly more expensive vendor and asked unnecessary questions, including about the witnesses' qualifications when he had been deposed hundreds of times, including by Plaintiff's firm. Ford does not contend the deposition itself was not reasonably necessary but disputes Plaintiff's counsel's choice of vendor and method of conducting the deposition. The Court DENIES the request to tax Item No. 4(e) in the amount of \$3,813.88. Ford also moves to tax a \$325.00 cancellation fee for an October 17 deposition. Ford contends it notified Plaintiff on October 13 as soon as it learned the witness became unavailable and provided an alternative date. (Abramova Decl., ¶ 6, Ex. A.) Ford contends no reasonable vendor charges a cancellation fee under these circumstances. Plaintiff contends it was issued a \$325.00 charge for the cancelled deposition. (Zakharian Decl., ¶ 23.) While Plaintiff further contends it "incurred" that charge and "was responsible" (Zakharian Decl., ¶¶ 24, 25) for that charge, Plaintiff does not demonstrate she actually paid for that charge. The Court GRANTS the request to tax Item No. 4(e) in the amount of \$325.00. Item 8b(5): Witness Fees - \$500.00

		Ford moves to tax \$500 in witness fees for a cancelled vehicle inspection on the ground Plaintiff provides no explanation of how the flat fee was calculated, what it represents, or how it was “reasonably necessary” to the litigation. Plaintiff contends the cancellation was due to Ford’s expert failing to appear and Plaintiff making herself and her expert available for a rescheduled inspection. (Zakharian Decl., ¶ 30.) Plaintiff demonstrates the \$500 cancellation charge was paid in full and was an actual litigation expense arising from a scheduled expert inspection. (Zakharian Decl., ¶ 29.) The Court DENIES the request to tax Item No. 8b(5) in the amount of \$500.00.
5	Madani vs. 2900 & 2910 E. Miraloma Ave. LLC. 2025-01482955 Motion for Leave to File Amended Cross-Complaint	Defendant/cross-complainant 2900 & 2910 E. Miraloma Avenue LLC’s (Miraloma) Motion for Leave to File an Amended Cross-Complaint is GRANTED. “A party against whom a cause of action has been asserted in a complaint or cross-complaint may file a cross-complaint setting forth . . . [a]ny cause of action he has against a person alleged to be liable thereon, whether or not such person is already a party to the action, if the cause of action asserted in his cross-complaint (1) arises out of the same transaction, occurrence, or series of transactions or occurrences as the cause brought against him or (2) asserts a claim, right, or interest in the property or controversy which is the subject of the cause brought against him.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 428.10.) “[D]efendants may cross-complain against any person from whom they seek equitable indemnity. Defendants need only allege that the harm for which they are being sued is attributable, at least in part, to the cross-defendant.” (Weil & Brown, Cal. Prac. Guide: Civ. Pro. Before Trial (The Rutter Group 2025) Pleadings § 6:529, citations omitted.) “Cross-complaints for comparative equitable indemnity would appear virtually always transactionally related to the main action.” (<i>Time for Living, Inc. v. Guy Hatfield Homes/All American Development Co.</i> (1991) 230 Cal.App.3d 30, 38.) Leave to file a cross complaint “may be granted in the interest of justice at any time during the course of the action.” (Code Civ. Proc., § 428.50, subd. (c).) Analysis Miraloma seeks leave to file a cross-complaint against Towman Towing, Inc. (Towman).